



Lets Play Music

Lesson Plans

These lesson plans are intended to demonstrate how to put together a structured 30 minute lesson using the songs and activities from the Let's Play Music website. Each week we will take a different theme and aim to develop a broad base of musical skills in singing, listening, percussion, pitch, rhythm and understanding.

Ideally the songs should be sung together during the class with some form of accompaniment, piano or guitar would be great but kids are still perfectly happy just singing along together with the percussion instruments instead.

If you work through the material for each lesson plan as listed, it should last around 30 mins, but it is always important to be flexible. Sometimes one activity might be particularly successful and you'll want to do it for longer, or sometimes things don't go quite as planned, so it's always important to have a few old favourites 'up your sleeve'. **Circle games** and **Circle time songs** are always popular, and you can just slot them in if you have a few spare minutes to fill. Choose a quieter activity if they need to settle or something lively if they need to work off the wiggles!

The **Hello Song** which is at the beginning of every lesson can also be used as a Goodbye Song, this works particularly well in a music class where the children just come together for a weekly session. It's a great way to get started and bring the class to a close and helps little ones to understand the routine. If the music lesson is just a part of the normal school day, you may prefer to leave it out.

In the interest of clarity and ease of use, I have tried to avoid making these plans too wordy, and so only give in-depth directions for the more unusual or original activities. However, all the material can be found for reference on the Let's Play Music website. Search for the titles in bold using the search box on the right hand side of the homepage, to check for more details.

Colours

Focus - A lesson that teaches and practices colour recognition, encouraging children to appreciate the wonderful colours of everything around them. with a variety of musical fun activities.

- Learning solfege with chime bars or resonator bells
- Playing a variety of percussion instruments, recognising the steady beat and the rhythm.
- Listening skills, remembering patterns and echoing rhythms
- Singing together with actions - speech development and solo responses.
- Social skills; working in a group, following instructions and building confidence
- Imaginative movement to music.

Props needed:

- Resonator bells or a xylophone
- A variety of percussion instruments
- The printable sheet music and resources below.
- A cardboard staircase prop, to use with the little coloured chime bar people.
- A selection of coloured scarves or ribbons and streamers to use in musical movement.

This lesson is suitable for children from 2 - 6 years and should take around 35 mins, but many of the activities can be used again separately whenever you need a short engaging, musical activity at any other time. These activities are also great for inspiring and exploring colour before painting and craft activities.





1. Say Hello (see blog)

2. The Do - Re - Mi Staircase - This game teaches children the degrees of the solfège scale (Do, Re Mi, Fa, So, La, Ti, Do). It teaches the correct order, the solfège colours and how they sound.

Using a staircase to illustrate each step or note is an engaging and visual way of teaching the spacial relationship between notes and intervals in a way that children find easy to understand. This is such valuable preparation for learning to play an instrument later on. I have found this game to be so popular and useful as a teaching tool that it is really worth including as a regular part of any preschool music lesson.

See Introducing Chime Bars for more information about teaching chime bars)

You can make your stairs by using our sheet below as a template and mounting it on strong card. My Do Re Mi steps are cut out of wood, which you could do if you are handy with a saw, or know someone who is. On the reverse side of the staircase you need to make little pockets out of duck tape behind each step so that you can slot the characters into their correct position. Alternatively there is a Bell Step Ladder available on Amazon (<http://amzn.to/23ksFjU>) which would be more durable. You could attach our little Do Re Mi characters to wooden bricks which would work very well and probably stand up to more use.

Once the children know which colour goes with which chime bar there are loads of different games you can play:- First make sure the children are familiar with the Do Re Mi scale. Depending on the age of the children, take time to introduce each character making sure the children are able to recognise and name each colour and note. This can be spread over several lessons.

Keep the chime bars hidden in a box or bag and use a puppet to ask the children to help put the chime bars in the correct order. Whilst you do this, place the little people onto their corresponding stair on the staircase as the kids identify each degree of the scale..

Let the children take turns to give the puppet clues about which chime bar comes next;

(i.e "It's the same colour as a banana!")

This is perfect if you have a group of children with mixed abilities, as the puppet can either help or be helped by the child depending on their age and ability.

Start with low Do and work your way up the steps

until every note is in place.

Finally, sing the colour clues together like a little song using the sheet below.

Another very popular game is to hide the chime bars or little people around the room and let the children hunt for them, identifying them and putting them in the correct order of the scale as they go.

- 3. I Can Sing A Rainbow-** Using the sheet music below, play and sing together with piano (if possible) and percussion instruments.

1st time identify and accentuate the steady beat.

2nd time, identify and accentuate the rhythm (the same as the words)

3rd time, choose just the wooden instruments to play.

4th time, choose just the bells and triangles.

Last time, play and sing loudly all together.

- 4.** If time allows you could read a short story book about colour, you may have a favourite, but here are a couple of good suggestions;

'What makes A Rainbow?' (<http://amzn.to/23ku0as>)

'Monsters Love Colors!' (<http://amzn.to/23ku36b>)

- 5. Magic Feet Follow The Beat!** By now the children will be ready for some movement. Use the sheet below to play this game, it's a brilliant way to have some fun with some lively movement, while learning and practising the concept of note values.

Use a tambourine to tap the beat, and once they have 'rubbed the magic on their feet', they are really in the mood to stamp around with giant steps like Daddy whole note (semibreves) or march like Big Brother 1/4 note (crotchets) or run along with little fast steps like The Little 1/8 Note Twins (quavers). When they've got the hang of each different note and the sound and action it makes, you can experiment with making them guess which one you are playing and try to catch them out, or each child can have a go at tapping the correct beat when you call out the note.

- 6. What's My Colour? Song and Guessing Game**

This song is brilliant for encouraging them to really listen to the clues as well as building musical confidence through call and response.



*My colour's cool and pure,
Like sky or water ,
Guess what you think it is?
(child answers) "I think it's blue!"*

*My colour's clean and fresh,
Like a cucumber,
Guess what you think it is?
(child answers) "I think it's green!"*

*My colour's warm and hot,
Just like a chilli,
Guess what you think it is?
(child answers) "I think it's red!"*

*My colour's like the sun,
Or a banana!
Guess what you think it is?
(child answers) "I think it's yellow"*

*My colour's dark as ink,
Just like a spider!
Guess what you think it is?
(child answers) "I think it's black"*

(sheet music below - or listen to the chime bar clip on the blog.)

This song is a great one for circle time, as it really engages the children and they are always so keen to show you how good they are at listening to the clues and naming the colours. For children of 2-3 years: you can use a variety of different coloured props. This depends on what you have handy or whether you are exploring a particular theme, but show the correctly coloured item as you sing each verse, and they will soon get the idea.

For children of 3-4 years: try hiding small coloured toys or bricks in a bag. Choose one to hold in your hand – but don't show it – ask them to guess the colour by listening to the clues.

For children of 4-6 years: pass the bag around the circle, each child takes a turn to pick an item and hide it in their hand. They then sing the clues and everyone else guesses the colour.

Encourage them to experiment with different clues – there is plenty of scope for some imaginative improvisation!



You can develop this game further by making it into a treasure hunt. Hide the objects around the room and ask the children to search for each coloured item in turn. As you sing each verse (you might have to repeat it a few times while their hunting!) they will spot the different coloured items on their way, but they must not touch them until that colour is requested. This also serves as a memory game because they must try to remember where each different coloured item can be found.

- 7. Free Musical Movement** with brightly coloured, scarves, ribbons or streamers. Put on some uplifting classical music and invite the children to dance and twirl around the room with their scarves and enjoy the colourful display.
Suggested music here (<https://youtu.be/7SZN8Ds7a2g>)
(<https://youtu.be/FaxTRX9oAV4>)

8. The Butterfly Song

*Oh butterfly, butterfly, butterfly blue,
I'd like to fly like you,
Butterfly, butterfly, butterfly blue,
I'd like to fly like you!*

*

*Butterfly, butterfly, butterfly pink,
What do you think, butterfly pink?
Butterfly, butterfly, butterfly pink,
What do you think, butterfly pink?*

*

*Butterfly, butterfly, butterfly yellow,
Let me catch you, just to say Hello!
Butterfly, butterfly, butterfly yellow,
Let me catch you, just to say Hello!*

*

*Butterfly, butterfly, butterfly green,
Where have you been, butterfly green?
Butterfly, butterfly, butterfly green,
Where have you been butterfly green?*

9. The Butterfly Song is very easy to pick up largely due to its repetitive phrases see the chime bar clip on the blog . If you combine this song with the accompanying craft activity the children can make their own butterflies to flutter as they sing



the song. These little butterflies are very simple and quick to make and are a lovely way to bring The Butterfly Song to life.

10. Treasure - Kids love playing this game and it's a real favourite to finish off the 'colours' theme, if you can gather a collection of different coloured objects to play with - check the post on the blog for full directions. <http://www.letsplaykidsmusic.com/treasure-a-musical-game-for-guessing/>

11. Say Goodbye (same as the Hello Song)

SUMMARY

Say Hello

Do-Re-Mi Staircase and Chime bar people (see sheet below for sung clues)

I can Sing a Rainbow - with percussion & singing (sheet music below)

Read a short book about colour What makes A rainbow? or "Monster's love colours!"

Magic Feet Follow The Beat (sheets included)

What's my Colour - guessing game

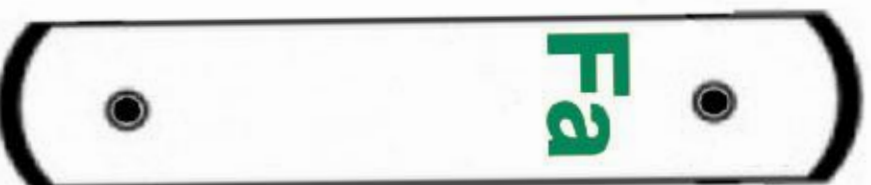
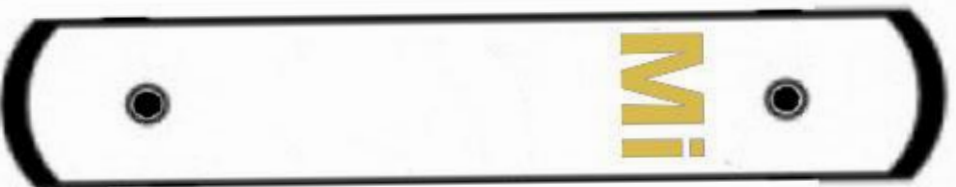
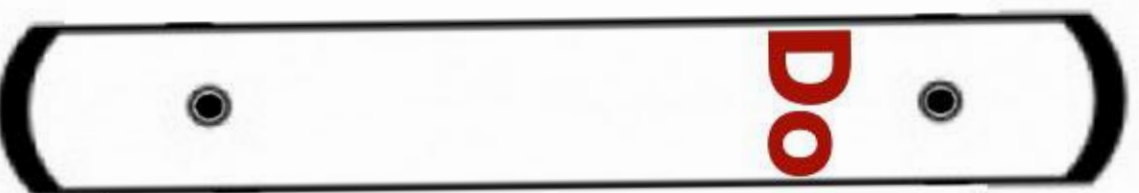
Movement to music - with coloured ribbons or scarves to The Blue Danube or Waltz of the Flowers

The Butterfly Song

Treasure With a collection of different coloured small items

Say Goodbye





AND 'DO' IS
WHAT D'YOU THINK?



DO



TI

IS LIKE A
RIPE PLUM



LA

IS LIKE SOME INK



SO

IS LIKE THE OCEAN



FA

IS LIKE A SALAD



MI

IS LIKE THE SUNSHINE



RE

IS LIKE A CARROT



DO

IS LIKE A STRAWBERRY

LET'S PLAY MUSIC



I Can Sing a Rainbow



RED AND YE-LLOW AND PINK AND GREEN, ORANGE AND, PU-RPLE AND BLUE

I CAN SING A RAIN-BOW, SING A RAIN-BOW, SING A RAIN-BOW TOO! -- LISTEN WITH YOUR EYES

LISTEN WITH YOUR EYES AND SING EVERYTHING YOU SEE,-- YOU CAN SING A RAINBOW, SING A RAINBOW, SING A-LONG WITH ME!

RED AND YE-LLOW AND PINK AND GREEN, ORANGE AND, PU-RPLE AND BLUE

WE CAN SING A RAIN-BOW, SING A RAIN-BOW, SING A RAIN-BOW TOO!

★ ★ Magic Feet ★ ★ ★ ★ Follow The Beat! ★ ★

A FUN WAY TO TEACH MUSIC NOTE VALUES!

BIG DADDY
WHOLE
NOTE



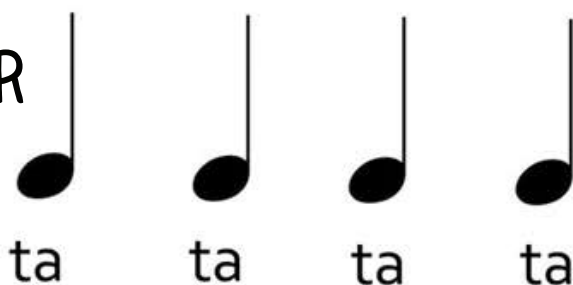
4 BEATS
GREAT BIG
GIANT FEET

MOMMY
HALF NOTE



2 BEATS
WALKS QUITE
SLOWLY

BIG BROTHER
QUARTER
NOTE



1 BEAT
MARCHES LIKE
A SOLDIER

LITTLE
TWINS
EIGHTH
NOTE



SHARE A BEAT
LITTLE TINY
STEPS
RUN ALONG
BEHIND

★ ★ Magic Feet ★ ★ ★ ★ Follow The Beat! ★ ★

A FUN WAY TO TEACH MUSIC NOTE VALUES!

DADDY SEMIBREVE



ta-a-a-a

4 BEATS

GREAT BIG
GIANT FEET

MUMMY MINIM



ta-a



ta-a

2 BEATS

WALKS QUITE
SLOWLY

BIG
BROTHER
CROTCHET



ta



ta



ta



ta

1 BEAT

MARCHES LIKE
A SOLDIER

LITTLE
QUAVER
TWINS



ti - ti

ti - ti

ti - ti

ti - ti

SHARE A BEAT

LITTLE TINY
STEPS
RUN ALONG
BEHIND

What's My Colour? Guessing Song



(THIS MELODY IS BORROWED FROM THE TRADITIONAL CANADIAN GIRL GUIDES CANOE SONG)

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